

Zadkiel AHARONIAN

Platform Engineer · Developer Experience · Cloud Native OSS

Toulouse, France · hello@zadkiel.fr · github.com/aslafy-z · linkedin.com/in/zadkielaharonian

I build **developer platforms** for teams that need reliable Kubernetes, GitOps and delivery, without turning product teams into platform experts. I've run **Kubernetes at scale** across public and sovereign clouds, on-prem and the edge. My work sits at the intersection of **Developer Experience**, reliability and open source, and I'm proudest of the OSS I maintain: **1,000+ merged upstream PRs**. Now exploring how agentic AI reshapes platform engineering.

EXPERIENCE

Cloud Specialist · Airbus Aircraft Jun 2024 — Present
Cloud-native and edge platforms for next-generation onboard aircraft systems.

- Delivered 5+ MVPs for next-generation onboard platforms, from concept to production-ready.
- Designed Kubernetes foundations for onboard application management and rollout-constrained environments.
- Built a **Varnish**-powered video distribution system for onboard content delivery.
- Enabled **real-time computer vision** at the edge on **Jetson** hardware with optimized pipelines.
- Built an AWS landing zone (Control Tower, AFT) with self-service account vending, and designed its dev-to-prod security gates.

DevOps Consultant · CCL Consulting Apr 2019 — Present
Kubernetes platform engineering and DevOps consulting across public and sovereign clouds.

- Led development of a **self-service Kubernetes platform product** that provisions clusters and a complete, batteries-included app ecosystem from declarative config across local, cloud and bare-metal, with layered Helm/Kustomize composition and automated SBOM/dependency discovery.
- Developed a **Kubernetes compliance engine** for real-time security and best-practice visibility across developers, compliance teams and operators.
- Delivering platform maintenance and enhancements across client environments using immutable infrastructure, GitOps workflows and modern security practices to 10+ client teams.

Site Reliability Engineer · Carrefour Dec 2020 — May 2024
Internal Kubernetes platform team for Carrefour product teams, across GKE, Rancher RKE, Azure IaaS/Kubespray and AKS.

- Operated and modernized 10+ Kubernetes clusters across multiple clouds, up to 200 nodes each, serving 50 product teams.
- Led Kubespray to RKE and **RKE to AKS migration** with GitOps, immutable infrastructure and security guardrails, delivering high availability and zero-downtime cluster upgrades.
- Built self-service Kubernetes platform capabilities, **GreenIT** resource-efficiency practices, runbooks, alert tuning and active on-call incident response.
- Developed and contributed to Kubernetes controllers/operators for multi-tenancy, logging and platform automation.

Software Engineer / Infrastructure Architect Jan 2016 — Dec 2020
Earlier engineering roles
Airbus Group Inc. and Aestetype Design: Python network/security automation, Tufin/NetBox/Centreon/Palo Alto/IPFabric data flows, Jenkins/Vault foundations, and Docker/Kubernetes product modernization.

OPEN SOURCE

aslafy-z/helm-git MAINTAINER
Helm plugin to install charts and values straight from Git repositories. **360+ stars**.

stakater/application MAINTAINER
Generic production Helm chart with schema-validated values. **370+ stars**.

kube-logging/logging-operator CORE CONTRIBUTOR
Operator-driven log collection, routing and delivery as declarative resources. **1,600+ stars**.

Ecosystem contributions CONTRIBUTOR
1,000+ merged PRs: Argo CD, Cilium, Kyverno, Talos, Helm, Kargo, Scaleway CCM, Ansible, Renovate, Prometheus Operator, External Secrets, Pluto...

Production-grade homelab
Talos/Kubernetes GitOps lab validating platform patterns: Cilium, Rook/Ceph, SOPS/age, observability.

SKILLS

Platform Engineering
Kubernetes · Talos · AKS · GKE · EKS · RKE · kubeadm · Kubespray · Cluster API · Operators · Rook/Ceph · Docker · containerd · Harbor · Chaos engineering

Developer Experience
Self-service platforms · Internal tooling · Helm · Kustomize · GitOps · Argo CD · Flux CD · Argo Rollouts · Argo Workflows · Kargo · Tekton · KEDA · Renovate · GitHub Actions · GitLab CI · Jenkins

Observability / Reliability
Prometheus · Thanos · Mimir · VictoriaMetrics · Alertmanager · Grafana · Loki · Fluent Bit · Fluentd · OpenTelemetry · Tempo · Incident response · Alert tuning · Runbooks · Zero-downtime upgrades

Security / Supply chain
Kyverno · OPA · Gatekeeper · Falco · Trivy · Syft/Grype · Cosign · SBOM · Vault · External Secrets · cert-manager · Keycloak/OIDC · Velero

Networking
Cilium · Calico · Canal · Gateway API · ingress-nginx · Traefik · Envoy Gateway · WireGuard

Cloud / Edge / IaC
AWS · Azure · GCP · Scaleway · OVHcloud · Terraform · Pulumi · Crossplane · Ansible · Packer · NVIDIA Jetson

Programming
Go · Python · TypeScript · Shell · Rust · C/C++

AI
AI-assisted engineering · Agentic coding workflows · Developer automation · ChatOps · KServe · vLLM · LiteLLM · Computer vision · GPU compute

EDUCATION

University of Kent
MSc, Computer Science · Cyber Security
Sep 2016 — Sep 2017

EPITECH
Engineering degree, Computer Programming
Dec 2013 — Dec 2018

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) 
The Linux Foundation · Dec 2021
Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS) 
The Linux Foundation · Feb 2023

INTERESTS

Technology
Technology watch · IoT · AI · Self-hosting · Local-first
Sports & outdoors
Hiking · Rock climbing · Cycling
Food & fermentation
Hot pepper sauces · Gourmet pickles · World cuisines

LANGUAGES

French Native
English Fluent